

Burns - Chemical - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1134 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- UAT-only emergency recognition and decontamination pathway for suspected chemical exposure causing a skin or eye burn; not approved for real-patient or production use.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [YES_NO] Is the scene safe to approach without exposing the caller or responder to fumes, liquid, powder, contaminated clothing, fire, or another hazard?
2. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the patient's exact age, what product or chemical was involved, and is the label or safety data sheet available without delaying first aid?
3. [LOCATION] Did the chemical contact the skin, eyes, face, mouth, airway, or clothing, and how large is the affected area?
4. [YES_NO] Is there breathing difficulty, coughing, choking, collapse, reduced responsiveness, severe eye pain, or vision change?
5. [YES_NO] Has contaminated clothing been removed safely, has any dry chemical been brushed away, and has appropriate irrigation started?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Burns - Thermal

Was the burn caused only by heat, flame, hot liquid, or steam, with no chemical or acid exposure?

A heat-only burn belongs in the Burns - Thermal pathway. Any chemical or acid exposure remains here.

1. Disposition level 100

Has a harmful acid, alkali, cleaning product, industrial chemical, or unknown chemical contacted the skin or eyes, or caused pain, burning, visible injury, breathing symptoms, or reduced responsiveness? If the substance or exposure type is uncertain, keep this emergency disposition and do not redirect to a combined or lower-acuity burn pathway.

NHS.UK treats acid or chemical exposure to skin or eyes as an emergency requiring immediate first aid and hospital assessment. Uncertainty must fail closed because chemical identity changes decontamination risks.

Advice

Chemical exposure â€” call Qatar 999

- Call Qatar 999 immediately and follow the operator's instructions. Do not enter a contaminated area or touch the chemical without suitable protection. Move away from fumes only if this can be done safely. Using gloves or another protective barrier, carefully cut away contaminated clothing rather than pulling it over the head; do not remove material stuck to skin. Brush visible dry powder away without spreading it or exposing the responder. Unless the product label, safety data sheet, or 999 operator specifically warns that water is unsafe for that substance, immediately irrigate affected skin or eyes with copious cool or lukewarm running water for about 1 hour. Let runoff flow away from unaffected skin and the other eye. Remove contact lenses only if easy and continue irrigation. Do not scrub, rub, neutralize with another chemical, apply cream, ointment, ice, or medicine, or delay irrigation while identifying the product. Keep the container or a photograph available for emergency responders if safe. Do not drive the patient to hospital. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: worsening pain; vision changes if eyes affected.

First aid

- Call Qatar 999 immediately and follow the operator's instructions. Do not enter a contaminated area or touch the chemical without suitable protection. Move away from fumes only if this can be done safely. Using gloves or another protective barrier, carefully cut away contaminated clothing rather than pulling it over the head; do not remove material stuck to skin. Brush visible dry powder away without spreading it or exposing the responder. Unless the product label, safety data sheet, or 999 operator specifically warns that water is unsafe for that substance, immediately irrigate affected skin or eyes with copious cool or lukewarm running water for about 1 hour. Let runoff flow away from unaffected skin and the other eye. Remove contact lenses only if easy and continue irrigation. Do not scrub, rub, neutralize with another chemical, apply cream, ointment, ice, or medicine, or delay irrigation while identifying the product. Keep the container or a photograph available for emergency responders if safe. Do not drive the patient to hospital. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- Hamad Medical Corporation, "Life-Threatening Medical Emergency", <https://hamad.qa/EN/Emergency/Pages/Life-ThreateningMedicalEmergency.aspx> (accessed 25 July 2026)
- Hamad Medical Corporation, "Al Wakra Hospital Emergency Quick Guide", 2025, https://hamad.qa/EN/Hospitals-and-services/alwakra/Patients-and-Visitors/Documents/PF%20Materials/AWH-Quick-Guide_Emergency.pdf (Qatar Poison Center 4003 1111)
- NHS.UK, "Acid and chemical burns", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/acid-and-chemical-burns/> (page last reviewed 05 June 2024)
- NHS England, "Management of self-presenters from hazardous-material incidents", 2026, <https://www.england.nhs.uk/long-read/the-management-of-self-presenters-from-incidents-involving-hazardous-materials-or-chemical-biological-radiological-nuclear-cbrn-substances/>

Provenance

Shaped to mirror the licensed After-Hours Telehealth Triage Guidelines database structure. This is IST open-source guideline content derived from the cited public sources; it is not licensed STCC content. Question.DispositionLevel=null marks a See More Appropriate Guideline redirect and is not a disposition row. Demographic variants contain only source-supported differences; identical thresholds are explicitly documented rather than fabricated. Local destination mappings and TelemedicineEligible values require IST clinical governance approval. UAT DATA ONLY - NOT FOR REAL-PATIENT CARE OR PRODUCTION USE.

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